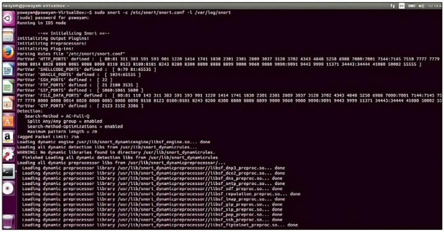

Figure 2: Executing Snort

Figure 3: A look at Snort options

directory. This file contains the alerts generated while Snort was running. Snort alerts are classified according to their type. A Snort rule specifies a priority for an alert as well. This lets you filter out low priority alerts to concentrate on the most worrisome. One can also run Snort as a daemon process by using the *–D* option as shown in the following command:

```
pswayam@pswayam-VirtualBox:~$ snort -D -c /etc/snort/snort.
conf -l /var/log/snort/
```

Note that if you want to be able to restart Snort by sending the SIGHUP signal to the daemon, you will need to use the full path to the Snort binary, when you start it.

You can type *snort –help* to get a clearer understanding of the various options that are available with Snort.

How to use Snort

Let us now understand how to use Snort in various modes. As mentioned earlier, Snort can be configured in three modes – Sniffer mode, packet logger mode and network intrusion detection mode.

In Sniffer mode, Snort will be able to print TCP/IP packet headers to the screen. This can be done by using the following command:

```
pswayam@pswayam-VirtualBox:~$ snort -v
```

If you want Snort to display packet data as well as the headers, you need to add the *–d* option as shown below:

```
pswayam@pswayam-VirtualBox:~$ snort -vd
```

In some cases, we may even be interested in a more descriptive display and for this, we need to use the *–e* option.

In packet logger mode, the main idea is to record the packets to the disk. In this mode, we need to specify a logging directory and Snort will automatically know how to get into the packet logger mode. A simple command to operate Snort in this mode looks like this:

```
pswayam@pswayam-VirtualBox:~$ snort -dev -l ./log
```

The above command assumes that you have a directory named *log* in the current directory. If that is not the case, Snort will exit with an error message. As expected, in order to log relative to the home network, you just need to tell Snort which the home network is. Another useful mode for logging is the *binary mode* and in this, Snort logs the packets in *tcpdump* format to a single binary file located in the logging directory. The following command shows how binary mode can be used:

```
pswayam@pswayam-VirtualBox:~$ snort -dev -l ./log -b
```

You can see from the above command that there is no need to specify the verbose mode or *–d* /*-e* switches. This is because, in binary mode, the entire packet is logged, not just parts of it.

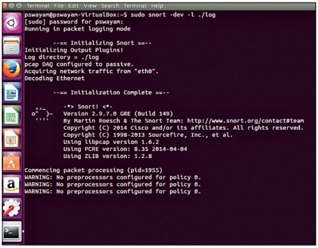

Figure 4: Snort in packet logger mode